

WHAT IS A GERUND?

- A **gerund** is the **-ing form of a verb** that functions as a **noun** in a sentence.
- Example: *Swimming is fun.* (Here, *swimming* is a noun, not a verb.)

👉 In Italian, gerunds (**gerundio**) exist, but they are mostly used to describe actions in progress (e.g., *Sto mangiando* = "I am eating"). In English, gerunds can also act as **subjects** or **objects** of a sentence.

HOW TO USE GERUNDS:

A. As the Subject of a Sentence:

- *Cooking is my passion.* (*Cucinare è la mia passione.*)
- *Reading helps improve vocabulary.* (*Leggere aiuta a migliorare il vocabolario.*)

👉 In Italian, infinitives (**-are, -ere, -ire**) are more common in these cases.

B. As the Object of a Verb:

Some verbs must be followed by a **gerund** (not the infinitive).

- *I enjoy swimming.* (*Mi piace nuotare.*)
 - *She suggested going to the park.* (*Ha suggerito di andare al parco.*)
- ♦ **Common verbs that have a gerund after them:** enjoy, suggest, avoid, mind, finish, consider, keep, practice.

C. After Prepositions:

- *I'm good at drawing.* (*Sono bravo a disegnare.*)
- *She left without saying goodbye.* (*Se n'è andata senza dire addio.*)

👉 In Italian, an infinitive follows a preposition (e.g., *senza dire* instead of *senza dicendo*).

D. After Certain Expressions:

- *It's no use complaining.* (*È inutile lamentarsi.*)
- *I can't stand waiting.* (*Non sopporto aspettare.*)



The Difference Between Gerunds & Present Continuous

- **Gerund** → acts as a noun (*Swimming is fun.*).
 - **Present Continuous** → continuous actions or actions in progress (*She is swimming.*).
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Common Mistakes by Italian Learners

1. Using the infinitive instead of the gerund

✗ *I enjoy to swim.*

✓ *I enjoy swimming.*

2. Forgetting to use the gerund after prepositions

✗ *I'm interested in learn English.*

✓ *I'm interested in learning English.*

3. Confusing gerunds with continuous verb forms

✗ *Reading this book, it is very interesting.* (Incorrect sentence structure)

✓ *Reading this book is very interesting.*

PRACTICE EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Complete the Sentences (Verb + Gerund)

Fill in the blanks with the correct **gerund form (-ing)** of the verbs in parentheses.

1. I enjoy _____ (cook) for my friends on weekends.
 2. She suggested _____ (go) to the new Italian restaurant.
 3. He avoided _____ (talk) about his problems.
 4. They finished _____ (watch) the movie late at night.
 5. I don't mind _____ (help) you with your project.
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Exercise 2: Correct the Mistakes

Each sentence has a mistake. Rewrite them correctly.

1. She enjoys to dance.
 2. They suggested to go to the beach.
 3. It's no use to cry over spilled milk.
 4. To read is my favorite hobby.
 5. Running is fun but to swim is better.
 6. John hates wake up early.
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Exercise 3: Create Your Own Sentences

Write **six sentences** using gerunds:

1. As a subject (e.g., "Swimming is fun.")
 2. After a verb (e.g., "I enjoy reading.")
 3. After a preposition (e.g., "He is good at cooking.")
 4. *I can't stand... gerund*
 5. *I hate... gerund*
 6. *I enjoy... gerund*
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Exercise 4: Multiple Choice (Choose the Correct Gerund Form)

Select the correct option to complete each sentence.

1. She can't help _____ when she watches a sad movie.
a) cry
b) crying
c) to cry



2. I look forward to _____ from you soon.
a) hear
b) to hear
c) hearing
 3. They don't allow _____ in the office.
a) smoke
b) smoking
c) to smoke
 4. She kept _____ even though she was tired.
a) work
b) working
c) to work
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Exercise 5: Complete the Sentences Using Your Own Ideas

Complete the following sentences using a **gerund (-ing form)**.

1. I enjoy _____ in my free time.
 2. _____ is difficult but important.
 3. She is good at _____.
 4. I don't like _____ in public.
 5. He avoided _____ by taking a different route.
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